CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · NCERT-TYPE CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 14: **The Elephant and the Tragopan** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. 'The Elephant and the Tragopan' is a poem by: 1

(a) Ruskin Bond **(b)** Harivansh Rai Bachchan
(c) Vikram Seth **(d)** Rabindranath Tagore

2. What is being built that will destroy the bamboo? 1

(a) a reservoir **(b)** a railway **(c)** a factory **(d)** a bridge only

3. Which sentence about the trout is true? 1

(a) It owns the bamboo. **(b)** It leads the animals out of the valley.
(c) It welcomes the reservoir at first. **(d)** It warns the elephant.

4. The ending leaves the reader with a feeling of: 1

(a) boredom **(b)** amusement
(c) concern for the future **(d)** relief

5. The poem belongs to the type of verse known as a: 1

(a) limerick **(b)** sonnet **(c)** elegy **(d)** fable

6. Bamboo is important to the elephant and the tragopan because it is: 1

(a) a weapon **(b)** food and shelter **(c)** a toy **(d)** a bridge

7. 'Reservoir' means: 1

(a) a dry riverbed
(b) a mountain pass
(c) a forest clearing
(d) a large artificial lake for storing water

8. A tragopan is: 1

(a) a type of fish **(b)** a brightly coloured pheasant
(c) a mountain goat **(d)** a snake

9. The trout reacts to the reservoir by feeling: 1

(a) pleased about the extra space **(b)** angry
(c) sleepy **(d)** fearful

10. 'Contradictory' in the poem about human qualities means: 1

(a) alike **(b)** hidden
(c) opposite to each other **(d)** simple

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Who wrote 'The Elephant and the Tragopan'? 2

12. Explain: 'When the road comes, the forest goes.' 2

13. Why can the poem be called a fable? 2

14. What is a tragopan? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Describe the elephant as a speaker in the poem. 3

16. How does the poet use irony in the trout's reaction? 3

17. Write a note on the vocabulary of the poem: 'clan', 'fief', 'reservoir'. 3

OR

What do we learn about human nature from the poem? 3

18. What does the line 'You will all be homeless' suggest? 3

OR

What does the poem tell us about progress? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Describe the conversation among the animals and what it reveals about humans. 5

OR

How does Seth use simple language to convey a serious message? 5

20. Write a character sketch of the elephant. 5

OR

Write a letter from the tragopan to the government pleading to save the forest. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND